(Snippet of larger assignment)

5B.3.1 VISUAL STORYTELLING: THEMING

Dominant Narrative:
Procrastination is harmless and part of human nature.

Counter Narrative:
Procrastination is not inevitable, it's a pattern that can be broken.

Impact Goal:
To waste less time procrastinating, thus feel less guilt.

Central Theme Hacked Life Story:
Existential pressure relief through persistence and discipline.

FINAL CONCEPT

Self portrait collage
Four photos of myself, altered beyond recognition to resemble different emotions and states of mind. The colors and layout may loosely resemble that of Andy Warhol's work. Using photoshop and mixed media, I will interchange my face with textures, cut out or swap eyes, mouths, etc. I will take my time during post production to experiment - I know that to suit my working style better than to preplan everything, especially in creating something like this, where I have little prior experience and the product calls for abstraction.

The four portraits will show:

1. Procrastination, lazy, unproductive

Tired eyes turned away from each other, focused on different things, eyes off the prize. Bleak, beige/muted blue background color.

2. Existential pressure, overpowering mental pain

No facial features and misshaped head filled with loud textures. Textured, intense background.

3. Incentive to change, dedication

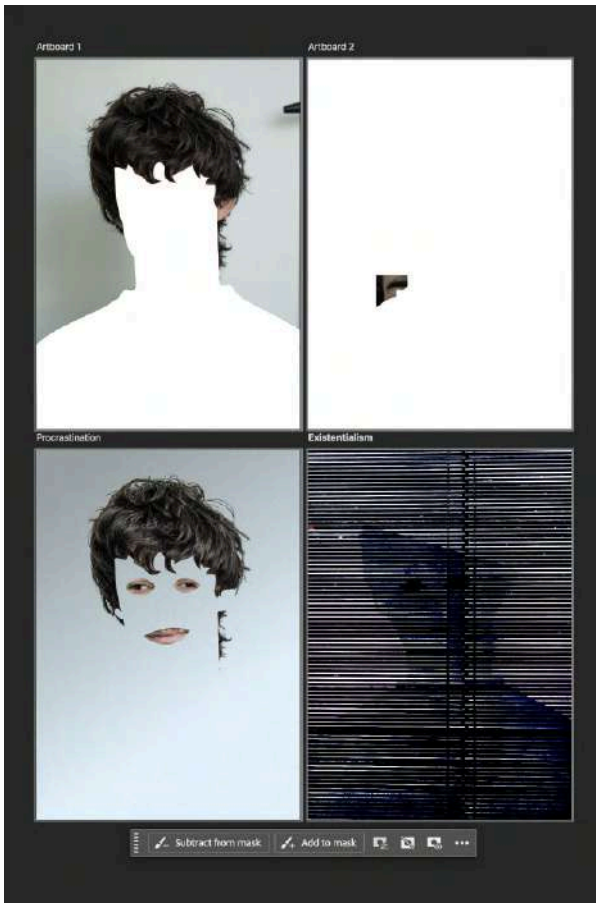
Eyes shut as if exerting force. Clenched teeth, but with a faint smile. Sunrise gradient in background.

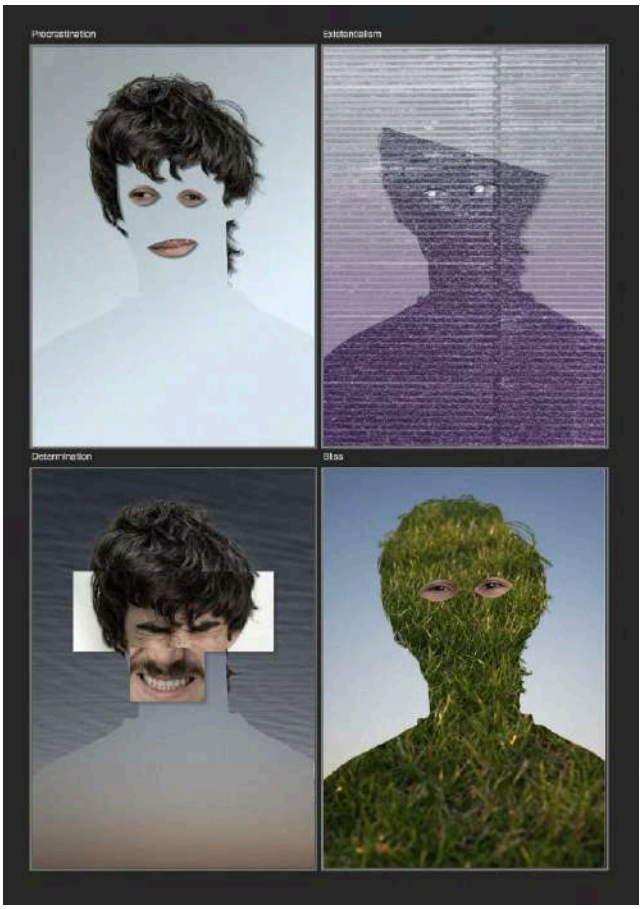
4. Relief from existential pressure

Relieved eyes resting on the horizon. Soft, bliss. Golden glow of morning in background.

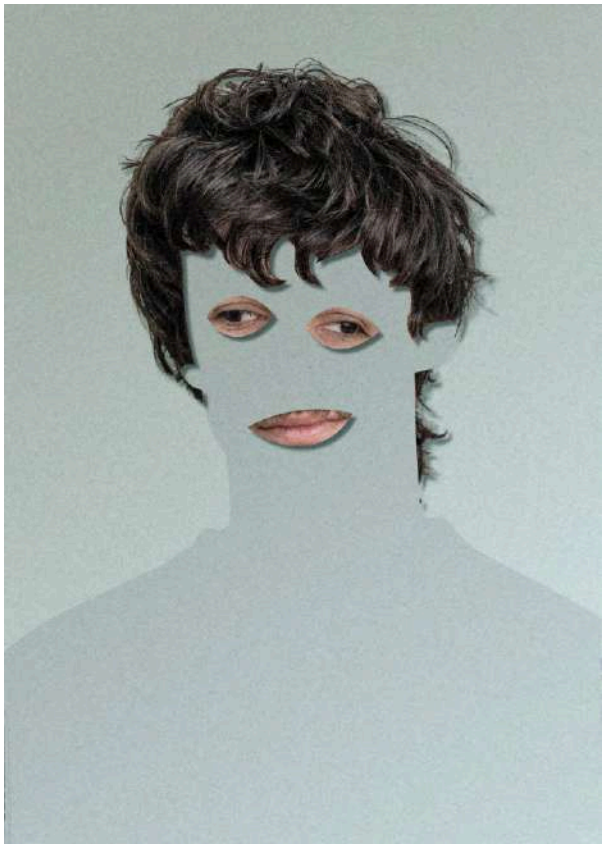
1 and 3 are actions, 2 and 4 are the outcomes of said actions.

7.3 VISUAL STORYTELLING: CREATION





Maybe I should have taken more snapshots of my process. Alas, I did not. Here are two. I spent a lot of time experimenting and tinkering. I know this is easy to say, but you can take my word for it.

I started out with only the self portraits as my tinker material. It got me going, but I felt something was missing. On my commute to school, making my way across Station Zuid, something suddenly caught my eye: a broken escalator. It had been stagnant for a long time, and had accumulated lots of dirt and debris between its ridges. Extremely self aware of my odd behaviour, I took a picture of the ground so I could use it as a texture for my "Existentialism Portrait". The filth filled escalator bears literal visual cues of stagnation - precisely what I needed.

In my concept, I talked about creating a digital gradient of a rising sun to resemble change. But when I was blessed with a lovely sunset tonight, I couldn't pass up the chance: nothing beats the real deal. Over the course of about forty five minutes, I shot multiple phases of the setting sun. I got the sky itself, water reflections and - my all time favorite color combination - the golden glow of the sunset covering green foliage, in this case the grass in my backyard. I knew this would serve as a lovely texture for my "Bliss Portrait"